

FABRICATED DOCUMENT — TEST FIXTURE

This is a synthetic evaluation rubric created for SlopChecker testing (repo policy #22). The Aldergrove Resilience Fund does not exist. This document is the scoring companion to `aldergrove-community-climate-rfp.md` and uses the same fictional funder, program officers, and solicitation number. Any resemblance to a real foundation is coincidental and unintended.

Aldergrove Resilience Fund

Community Climate Adaptation Grants — Evaluation Criteria and Scoring Rubric

Solicitation number: ARF-CCA-2026-03 **Applies to cycle:** 2026 Community Climate Adaptation Grants

Purpose of This Document

This rubric is provided to external review panelists scoring proposals submitted under solicitation ARF-CCA-2026-03. It is also shared with applicants so they understand how proposals will be evaluated. Each panelist scores every criterion independently on a 1–5 scale using the anchors below; criterion scores are weighted and summed to produce a single composite score per proposal, used to rank the applicant pool for funding recommendations to the Fund's board.

Weighting Summary

Criterion	Weight
Significance and Fit to Priority Areas	20%
Approach and Methodological Rigor	25%
Feasibility and Team Capacity	20%
Community and Municipal Partnership	20%
Dissemination and Sustainability	15%
Total	100%

A composite score is calculated as:

$$\text{composite} = 0.20 * (\text{Significance}) + 0.25 * (\text{Approach}) + 0.20 * (\text{Feasibility}) + 0.20 * (\text{Partnership}) + 0.15 * (\text{Dissemination})$$

on a resulting 1.0–5.0 scale. Proposals scoring below 3.0 composite are not recommended for funding regardless of budget availability.

Criterion 1: Significance and Fit to Priority Areas (20%)

Does the project address a genuine gap for small or mid-sized municipal adaptation practice, and does it fit one of the Fund's stated priority areas (urban heat, coastal/riverine flooding, or water scarcity)?

Score	Descriptor
5	Directly addresses a well-documented, high-consequence gap; clear fit to a named priority area; outcome would be adopted by multiple municipalities beyond the named partners.
4	Addresses a real gap with clear priority-area fit; benefit mostly limited to the named partner municipalities.
3	Plausible significance and fit, but the gap or its consequence is asserted rather than well-supported.
2	Weak or tangential fit to the stated priority areas; significance argument is generic.
1	No clear connection to municipal climate adaptation or to a stated priority area.

Criterion 2: Approach and Methodological Rigor (25%)

Is the proposed method sound, appropriately scaled to the budget and timeline, and likely to produce the claimed result?

Score	Descriptor
5	Method is rigorous, well-justified, and directly tied to the aims; any preliminary results are clearly described with methodology sufficient to assess credibility.
4	Method is sound and appropriate; minor gaps in justification of specific design choices.
3	Method is workable but has unaddressed limitations (e.g., sample size, control condition, validation approach).
2	Method has significant gaps that put the aims at risk; preliminary results, if claimed, are not well supported by the described methodology.
1	Method is not credible as described, or is disconnected from the stated aims.

Criterion 3: Feasibility and Team Capacity (20%)

Can this specific team complete this specific project within the proposed budget and period?

Score	Descriptor
5	Budget, timeline, and personnel are clearly matched to the scope of work; team has demonstrated relevant prior experience.
4	Feasible overall; budget or timeline is tight in one area but not disqualifying.
3	Feasible with moderate risk; some mismatch between scope and resources requires reviewer judgment.
2	Scope appears substantially larger than the budget or timeline can support.
1	Not feasible as proposed; budget, timeline, or personnel are clearly insufficient for the stated aims.

Criterion 4: Community and Municipal Partnership (20%)

Is the named municipal partnership real, committed, and structured to produce a tool the partner will actually use?

Score	Descriptor
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5	Partner(s) are named, committed in writing, and meaningfully involved in project design, not just as a data-collection site.
4	Partner(s) are named and committed in writing; involvement is somewhat more limited (e.g., site access only).
3	Partner(s) are named and described, but commitment documentation is incomplete or ambiguous.
2	Partner(s) are named but there is no clear evidence of an actual commitment.
1	No named municipal partner, or the described partnership does not meet the eligibility requirement.

Criterion 5: Dissemination and Sustainability (15%)

Will the results reach practitioners beyond the named partners, and does the project have a credible plan for the tool or workflow to outlive the grant period?

Score	Descriptor
5	Concrete dissemination plan (e.g., open documentation, workshop, training) targeting a specific practitioner audience beyond named partners, with a credible sustainability path after the award ends.
4	Clear dissemination plan; sustainability path is plausible but less developed.
3	Dissemination is mentioned but not planned in detail (e.g., "will publish results" with no venue or audience specified).
2	Dissemination is an afterthought; no meaningful plan to reach practitioners beyond named partners.
1	No dissemination or sustainability plan of any kind.

Panelist Notes

- Score each criterion independently; do not average across criteria in your head before recording individual scores.
- A proposal with a strong Approach score but a weak Partnership score (or vice versa) is a common and expected pattern — score each criterion on its own merits.
- Compliance issues (missing required sections or attachments, budget exceeding the \$75,000 ceiling) are handled separately by Fund staff during the eligibility screen described in `aldergrove-community-climate-rfp.md` and should not be re-litigated by panelists in the scoring above; a proposal that reaches panel review is assumed to have passed the compliance screen.